



USSD (Unstructured Supplementary Service Data)

USSD is a communication protocol used to send text messages. It establishes a real-time communication session between a phone and another device (Network or server) meaning it enables 2-way instant communication.

HOW IT WORKS

When a user dials in the USSD command (e.g *633#) and sends in a request, the USSD gateway forwards it to the user's USSD application which responds to the request.

USSD applications run on the network hence do not have to be installed on a user's device.

USES OF USSD

- Surveys
- Payment systems such as Mobile Banking
- Receiving Alerts and Notifications (e.g order confirmations)

Note: You need to have a menu that displays your product or service

GETTING STARTED

There are 2 types of USSDs to choose from:

1. **Dedicated USSD** – Entirely owned by the client (*456#)
2. **Shared USSD** – Owned by Celcom and the client gets an extension (*456*22#)

Onboarding Process

1. Celcom shares a list of available USSDs for the Client to pick one
2. Billing is done and payment processed in line with the quotation
3. USSD menu is developed.

Note: There are 2 options for USSD menu development

- Development is done on Client's side and a request of the USSD is forwarded to the Client's server
- Celcom does the menu development for the client at a cost that will be structured depending with the user case and work flows

Setup Duration

- Dedicated USSD – At least one month
- Shared USSD – Two to Three weeks

USSD COST IMPLICATIONS

1: DEDICATED SAFARICOM

NO:	DETAILS	PRICE
1	Connection-Set up (One -Off)	150,000 + VAT
3	Test Bed Monthly Charge	20,000 + VAT
4	Monthly Rental Fee	50,000 + VAT
5	2 Months rental Deposit	100,000 + VAT

NOTE: Currently Safaricom do not have any available dedicated ussds and therefore a client will have to go through the other 3 networks to get a dedicated ussd which can be set up on safaricom if confirmed available

2: DEDICATED AIRTEL

NO:	DETAILS	PRICE
1	Connection-Set up (One-off)	130,000 + VAT
2	Monthly Rental Fee	50,000 + VAT
3	1 Month Deposit Fee	50,000 + VAT

3: DEDICATED TELKOM

NO:	DETAILS	PRICE
1	Connection-Set up (One-off)	100,000 + VAT
2	Monthly Rental Fee	40,000 + VAT
3	1 Month Deposit Fee	40,000 + VAT

3: DEDICATED EQUITEL

NO:	DETAILS	PRICE
1	Connection-Set up (One-off)	55,000 + VAT
2	Monthly Rental Fee	15,000 + VAT
3	1 Month Deposit Fee	15,000 + VAT

4: SHARED USSD (Per Network)

NO:	DETAILS	PRICE
1	Connection-Setup	10,000 + VAT
2	Monthly Rental Fee	10,000 + VAT
3	1 Month Deposit Fee	10,000 + VAT

- DEVELOPMENT COSTS (USSD SCREENS/ADMIN DASHBOARDS) – From Kshs 140,000 depending on usecase and work flow
- HOSTING – Kshs 5,000 per month. This can be reviewed depending on usage every 6 months
- USSD SESSION CHARGES – Kshs 1.00 per session for dedicated USSD. You can choose to offset this to end-users. For shared USSD, this is free.

SUPPORT AND MAINTAINANCE

Celcom is committed to offering long term support and quick resolution to arising issues